

7.5 Cumulative fertility rates

At the 1971 Census information on children ever born was obtained from ever married women of the reproductive span. Cumulative fertility rates by age group are shown in Table 7.10. The average number of children born per woman in the 45-49 year age group i.e. those who may be regarded as having completed their reproductive life is 5.6.

TABLE 7.9 : AGE SPECIFIC MARITAL FERTILITY RATES 1963 - 1971 AND PERCENT CHANGE

Age Group	Age specific marital fertility rates		Percent change 1963 - 1971
	1963	1971	
15 - 19	354	382	+ 7.9
20 - 24	396	402	+ 1.5
25 - 29	344	316	- 8.1
30 - 34	270	232	-14.1
35 - 39	175	147	-16.0
40 - 44	53	46	-13.2
45 - 49	8	7	-12.5

TABLE 7.10 : LIVE BIRTHS BORNE BY EVER MARRIED WOMEN BY AGE AT THE 1971 CENSUS

Age Group	Live births born per ever married woman
15 - 19	0.584
20 - 24	1.492
25 - 29	2.720
30 - 34	3.945
35 - 39	5.140
40 - 44	5.222
45 - 49	5.605

7.6 Fertility differentials

Urban/Rural differentials - Table 7.11 attempts to summarize urban/rural differentials in fertility. The differentials exhibit the traditional pattern of lower urban fertility in relation to rural fertility. The ratio $R \times 100^6$ has decreased with the passage of time. These trends are consistent with greater modernization and urban influences pervading the rural areas.

TABLE 7.11 : URBAN-RURAL FERTILITY DIFFERENTIALS FOR SRI LANKA CHILD WOMAN RATIO (CHILDREN 0 - 4 PER 1000 FEMALES AGED 15 - 49)

Year	Urban	Rural	$\frac{\text{Rural}}{\text{Urban}} \times 100$
1953	549	672	123
1963	594	712	120
1971	492	569	116

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35-39
40-44
45-49